

Will McGowan

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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team
Goldman Sachs International
Plumtree Court, 25 Shoe Lane
London EC4A 4AU

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 EMEA London FICC and Equities (Sales and Trading) New Analyst Programme in London, with a particular interest in commodities. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Goldman Sachs's FICC business grew revenue 32% year on year in the second quarter of 2026, with commodities among the businesses driving the increase, and that is the part of the trading floor I most want to join.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, tests whether governments that hedge oil change how their currencies react to OPEC news: whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make the oil beta smaller, kinked or one-sided, and whether any beta that remains can be traded after costs. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously: at the Strathclyde Poker Society, where I was Vice-President and then President, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their own win rate, variance and appetite for risk call for.

Goldman Sachs's FICC franchise stands out to me because its scale across rates, currencies and commodities lets it keep making markets for clients through volatile periods; FICC net revenues reached \$4.59 billion in the second quarter of 2026, up 32% on the year, on higher activity in interest rate products, commodities and mortgages. My dissertation on how OPEC news moves currencies and my wheat spread strategy have taught me how quickly commodity risk can change, and I would like to learn how a desk manages that risk while still giving clients a price.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan